



Course Name

NIGERIAN PEOPLE'S & CULTURE

Topic: Nigerian People's & Culture

WEEK 3

IN SUMMARY

This week, you learned about the Portuguese incursion into the Niger Area in the 15th century and its significant impact on the region, including:

Opening up the area to the rest of the world, which eventually led to colonialism and exploitation.

Leading to a series of wars in order to be able to continue the supply of slaves.

Contributing to the abandonment of African cultures.

Playing a major role in the trans-Atlantic slave trade.

The Portuguese presence in the Niger Area also had a significant impact on the trans-Atlantic slave trade.

The Portuguese were the first European power to establish a regular trade in slaves from West Africa to the Americas. They were also responsible for developing the triangular trade route, which connected Europe, Africa, and the Americas.

The Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade was a massive and inhumane system that had a devastating impact on Africa. It is estimated that over 15 million Africans were sold as slaves and transported to the Americas. The slave trade also had a profound impact on European and American societies. It helped to shape the economies of these societies and contributed to the rise of racism and white supremacy.



BULLET POINT SUMMARY

- The lesson explores the impact of Portuguese exploration in the 15th century on West Africa, including their role in opening up the Niger area to the rest of the world.
- Portuguese sailors, motivated by the desire for new markets, began exploring the West African coast in the early 15th century, significantly improving seafaring techniques and ship designs.
- Portugal dominated world trade for nearly 200 years due to technological advancements and access to valuable commodities such as fabrics, spices, and gold.
- The Portuguese established trade relations along the Nigerian coast, impacting the growth of brass casting in Benin and the emergence of trading in the Lagos Lagoon.

CASE STUDY

Title: Portuguese Exploration and the Transformation of West Africa

Introduction: This case study delves into the early Portuguese exploration of the West African coast in the 15th century, focusing on their motivations, technological advancements, and the effects of their incursion on the region.

Objective: The objective is to understand how Portuguese exploration altered the dynamics of West Africa, leading to technological advancements, trade relations, and long-term consequences such as colonisation.

Methods: This case study employs historical analysis to examine the motivations of Portuguese sailors, the innovations in seafaring and trade, and the enduring impact on West African societies. It also explores the transition from the transatlantic slave trade to the era of colonialism and its implications.

QUESTIONS TO PONDER

- Can you visualise the scene of Portuguese caravels appearing on the West African coast in the 15th century and the impact of this encounter on the local population?
- Why were the Portuguese motivated to explore the West African coast, and how did their technological advancements, like the caravel, contribute to their success in seafaring?
- Think of the consequences of Portuguese exploration, such as the growth of trade relations and the impact on local industries like brass casting in Benin. How did these changes affect West African societies?
- Why do you think the end of the transatlantic slave trade led to a new era of exploitation through colonialism, and how did this alter the region's development?



SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES YOU HAVE ACQUIRED AFTER THIS LESSON

From our lesson, some skills and competencies you should have acquired include: Cross-Cultural Understanding: By studying the interactions between the Portuguese, African societies, and European powers, you will enhance your cross-cultural awareness and sensitivity.

Analytical Skills: You will be able to analyse the economic and technological factors that shaped the course of history, as well as the social and political consequences of these events.

PERSONAL REFLECTION

How can the historical events of Portuguese exploration and the transatlantic slave trade help you understand the world today? How might this knowledge change your view of current global issues, cultural interactions, and economic disparities?